

The Tricky Tailor

One day a prince was riding home after having been away for many, many years. He met another rider and the two of them **struck up a conversation**.

On learning about the prince's **homeward** trip, the newcomer who said he was a tailor, asked him how his parents, the King and Queen would recognize him. The prince **held out** a gold ring with the royal seal on it. "They'll recognize me when I show them this," he said.

The tailor **grinned slyly** to himself as he **hatched** a plan to **con** the prince.

They camped for the night in a **grove** of trees and the tailor offered the prince a glass of **sherbet laced with** a powerful sleeping drug. The prince **swallowed** the drink and **dropped down** in a **stupor**. The tailor quickly **filched** the ring, **mounted** his horse and rode away.

At the royal palace, the tailor showed the ring to the King and Queen and was welcomed as the long-absent prince.

Several hours later there was a **terrific commotion** and an angry young man was led before the king and queen. The young man **accused** the tailor of being an **impostor** who had stolen his ring and assumed his identity. The tailor **hotly** denied it and declared that he was the true prince.



The king was doubtful but the queen recognized the **newcomer** as her son. Since no positive proof was required she announced a test of skill with the winner being declared the true prince. Cloth and tailoring materials were given to the two men and they were ordered to make a shirt each.

"The one who makes the more beautiful garment will be accepted as the true prince," declared the queen.

Soon the contest began. The prince **made a mess** of his shirt but the tailor began a garment of great beauty.

"Aha! I've won!" he shouted **pointing to** the prince's **handiwork**. But to his surprise he was arrested and **clapped** in irons.

"You are an impostor and a tailor at that," said the Queen, "for only a tailor could have made such an **exquisite** garment."

The tailor **hung his head** and made no reply as the guards led him away to prison.

Vocabulary

1. **Tricky** (adjective) – cunning, sly, crafty, wily, deceitful धूर्त
2. **Strike up a conversation** (phrase) – start a chat, begin talking, open a conversation, break the ice, initiate talk बातचीत शुरू करना
3. **Homeward** (adjective) – homebound, returning, toward home, inbound, homegoing घर-वापसी का
4. **Hold out** (phrasal verb) – present, offer, extend, proffer, show पेश करना
5. **Grin** (verb) – smile broadly, beam, smirk, grin widely, flash a smile दाँत निकालकर मुस्कराना
6. **Slyly** (adverb) – cunningly, craftily, furtively, stealthily, shiftily चालाकी से
7. **Hatch** (verb) – devise, concoct, contrive, plot, engineer योजना रचना
8. **Con** (verb) – deceive, swindle, dupe, trick, defraud ठगना
9. **Grove** (noun) – copse, thicket, stand of trees, spinney, small wood उपवन
10. **Sherbet** (noun) – sweet drink, cordial, syrup drink, squash, sharbat शरबत
11. **Lace** (with) (verb) – spike, infuse, dose, adulterate, fortify मिलाना
12. **Swallow** (verb) – gulp, ingest, down, consume, drink निगलना
13. **Drop down** (phrasal verb) – collapse, fall, slump, keel over, go down धड़ाम से गिरना
14. **Stupor** (noun) – daze, torpor, trance, numbness, unconsciousness अचेत अवस्था
15. **Filch** (verb) – steal, pilfer, purloin, swipe, snatch चुरा लेना
16. **Mount** (verb) – get on, climb onto, ascend, bestride, hop on सवार होना
17. **Terrific** (adjective) – tremendous, huge, massive, intense, extreme जबरदस्त
18. **Commotion** (noun) – uproar, ruckus, turmoil, hullabaloo, disturbance हंगामा
19. **Accuse** (of) (verb) – charge with, allege, indict, blame, impute आरोप लगाना
20. **Impostor** (noun) – pretender, fraud, masquerader, sham, fake छद्मवेशी
21. **Hotly** (adverb) – heatedly, vehemently, angrily, passionately, fervently तीखे ढंग से
22. **Newcomer** (noun) – new arrival, stranger, entrant, novice, fresher नवागंतुक
23. **Make a mess** (phrase) – bungle, botch, spoil, ruin, make a hash गड़बड़ कर देना
24. **Point to** (phrasal verb) – indicate, show, highlight, gesture toward, signal इशारा करना

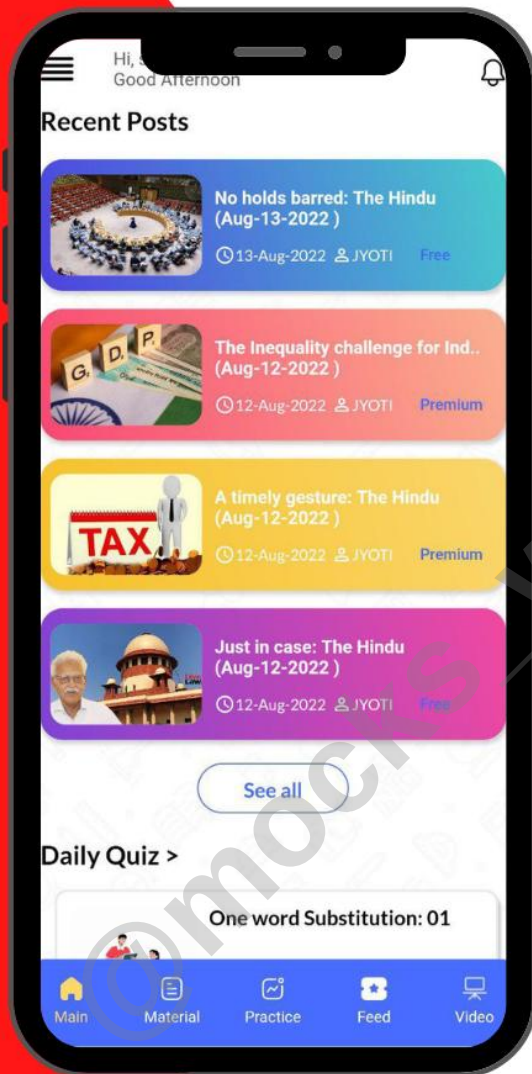
25. **Handiwork** (noun) – craftsmanship, workmanship, creation, product, output
कारीगरी

26. **Clap** (verb) – shackle, manacle, fetter, cuff, lock up
बेड़ियाँ डालना

27. **Exquisite** (adjective) – beautiful, elegant, superb, delicate, refined
बेहद सुंदर

28. **Hang one's head** (phrase) – lower one's head, bow in shame, look down, droop, be crestfallen
शर्म से सिर झुका लेना

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